

Debugging guide — capture the search failure (and verify the new fixes)

Date: 2026-06-23 · **For:** operator on-device debugging **Builds this targets:** client **1.3.11-1068** debug (`.client.dev`) + the on-device api-app debug (`.api.dev`)

Why this matters: the release-search root cause (401 vs connection-refused) is the ONE thing the autonomous loop can't self-serve — it needs a real HTTP status from your device. The **debug** build ships **Chucker** (an in-app HTTP inspector) + is adb-debuggable, so the debug pair is the fastest way to get it. New since the build you have: the failure is now **telemetered** (was silently dropped) and a failed search shows **Error** + a **working Retry** instead of a dead-end "Nothing found."

A. The 3-line readout I need (≈2 min) — highest priority

1. **Install the matched DEBUG pair** from Firebase App Distribution:
 - Lava client **.client.dev** (1.3.11-1068)
 - Lava API app **.api.dev** (Uninstall any prior release `.client` / `.api` first — a clean matched pair.)
2. Open **Lava API (.api.dev)** → start the engine → confirm its foreground notification shows running.
3. In the client: **fresh onboarding** → pick the on-device API → run a **search** (e.g. "ubuntu").
4. Open **Chucker** (its notification, or its launcher icon) → tap the most recent `/v1/{provider}/search` transaction. Report:
 - ☐ **status code** of `/v1/{provider}/search` — `200` / `401` / `404` / `5xx`, or "no such request".
 - ☐ is there a `/providers` request, and is it **200**?
 - ☐

does search **work** on this debug pair (results render)?

Decoder: /providers 200 + /v1/...search 401 → key/auth layer. Both fail / no request → engine unreachable. Works on debug but broken on release → release-only (R8/signing/config).

B. If Chucker isn't enough — adb logcat (needs USB + this Mac)

The new §6.AC telemetry records the failure cause to logcat + Crashlytics. With the phone USB-connected (USB debugging on):

```
adb logcat -c                # clear
# ... run a search in the app ...
adb logcat | grep -iE "lava|SearchResult|ApiBacked|Lava-Auth|HTTP|
    ProviderFailure|recordNonFatal|getString"
```

Look for the ApiBackedTrackerClient line API request failed: HTTP
<code> for <url> — that <code> is the answer.

C. Crashlytics (no cable needed)

The §6.AC fix means per-provider search failures now appear as **non-fatals** in Firebase Crashlytics (feature=search, operation=streamMultiSearch, provider=..., error_message=the HTTP status). After a failed search on the debug build, check the Crashlytics dashboard for a non-fatal with the HTTP <code> in its message + the provider/feature custom keys.

D. Verify the new fixes work (regression confirmation)

- **Error + Retry (cfe838bc):** make a search fail (e.g. point at an API that 401s / is down) → you should now see an **error state with a Retry button** (NOT "Nothing found"). Tap Retry against a working API → results render.
 - **Telemetry (922ecbca):** every failed search now leaves a Crashlytics non-fatal (per C above) — no more silent failures.
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E. What's distributed vs held (honest status)

Artifact	Status	Why
client debug (.client.dev 1.3.11-1068)	distributing now	§6.AA stage 1; has Chucker; for your debugging
client release (.client)	HELD	§6.Z: needs Challenge Tests executed on a device (thinker KVM gate in progress) — shipping release-without-device-gate is exactly what shipped the broken search
api-app debug+release	blocked	.env lacks LAVA_FIREBASE_API_APP_ID / _DEV_APP_ID (recovered nezha .env didn't include them; being extracted from api-app/google-services.json)

Once you give me the Section-A readout, I root-cause the exact layer, ship the fix, and — when the thinker device gate goes green — verify it on a real KVM emulator and release both apps.